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WHO I AM



I delivered a national textbook at 20.

And I've been quietly owning the whole thing ever since.

I'm a product design lead who also does the product-manager work — research, strategy, design and delivery, start to finish. Not just the screens.

25 years across print and digital. Born in Kyiv, raised in a print house, worked across London and Europe, now Product Design Lead at McKinsey.

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I make complicated things make sense.

For the people who use them — and the teams who build them.

I walk in where a product, service, workflow or brand is a mess, do the UX research to find what people *actually* need, and own it from first research to finished product.

My strength is translation: I speak "client" and I speak "engineer," and I turn one into the other without losing what matters.

I was a PM before the title existed.

No coordinators, no safety net. I always delivered on time.

For most of my career it was just me and the client — and later me, the client, and the dev team. I planned it, designed it, and managed everyone's expectations in both directions.

What that taught me: **no amount of tools fixes how people behave or how motivated they are.** That takes a human approach. Better processes and operations are the by-product of doing the research honestly.

Quietly, over the years: **20+ people hired, 15+ mentored, teams up to 15** — across London, Sydney, New York, Shanghai, Prague and more. I just never called it "management."

Proof, not adjectives.

25 years of measurable change, at a glance.

- **–80%** unapproved software installs after I redesigned the approval flow (McKinsey).
- **–20–25%** time-to-market leading a cross-functional team of **15** (Codewell).
- **–20%** production time & **–30–35%** brand inconsistencies by setting global brand rules (Hudson).
- **+30–35%** platform adoption for Lenovo, Philips & IBM work (Fox Hunter).
- **9 months** to ship a national textbook — at 20.
- **20+** hired · **15+** mentored · teams up to **15** · **10** cities.

The developers weren't slow — the brief was broken.

A knowledge platform connecting consultants with knowledge experts · my first McKinsey project, before AI was a thing.

The pain: partners burned days routing requests to the wrong knowledge teams; experts burned hours re-preparing the same generic info. The PM blamed the developers for slow delivery.

What I actually found: the developers weren't the problem — the project was. Sprint goals kept changing mid-sprint, and work reached engineers unclear: no research, no testing with stakeholders, and badly written JIRA stories. So I stopped just fixing bugs and rebuilt how the work ran: I brought in a data analyst to add automation that suggested the right team, ran stakeholder calls where we solved problems together, and shared plans openly so everyone could see the reason behind them.

I ran **1:1s with every developer and tester** to make sure each JIRA story was genuinely understood, and I sat in on the **user testing** myself — so the brief that reached engineering was clear, complete, and validated.

What changed: developers started owning their work, bugs dropped, more features delivered per sprint, and the team's mood lifted. Then the numbers followed:

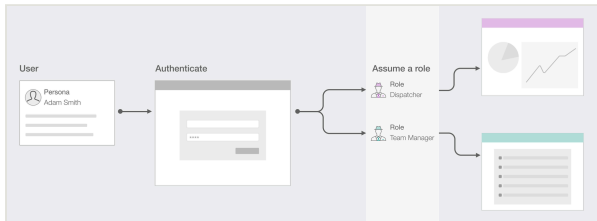
- Partner wait for the right team's report: **1 week → 3 days**.
- **+50%** correct knowledge-team match on the first try.
- **-40%** time lost to re-assignment, via redesigned workflows.
- Redesigned the experts' case-management back-end (from Excel to a real tool) and the front-end UI — all built on the **ServiceNow platform** — but the thing that actually worked was the **workflow redesign, clear communication to users** and **transparency with stakeholders**.

I drove the adoption — knowledge-library articles, release-note newsletters, and a Slack channel for fast troubleshooting. Building it was half the job; getting people to trust and use it was the other half.

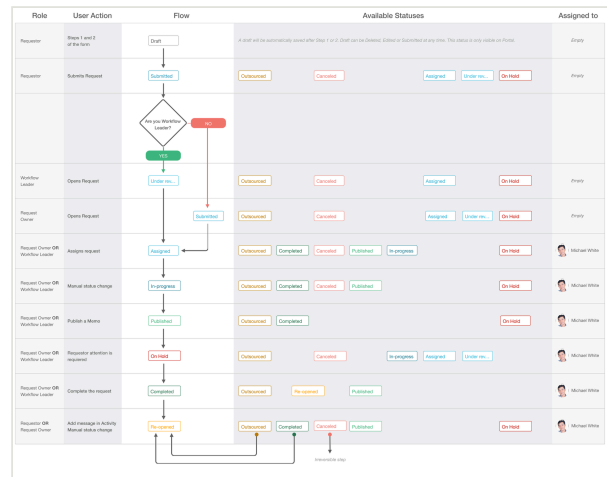
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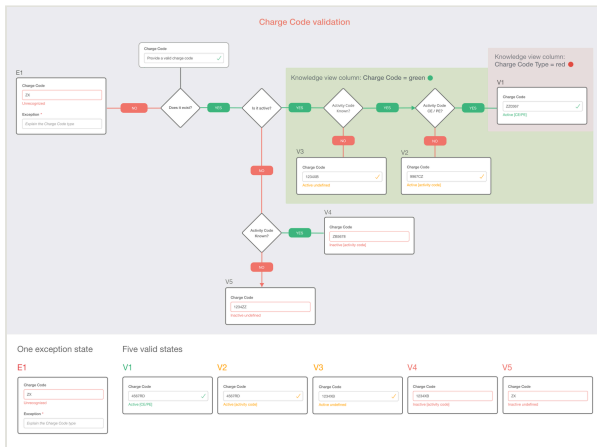
Research Insights — research · planning · back-end · front-end · alignment · adoption



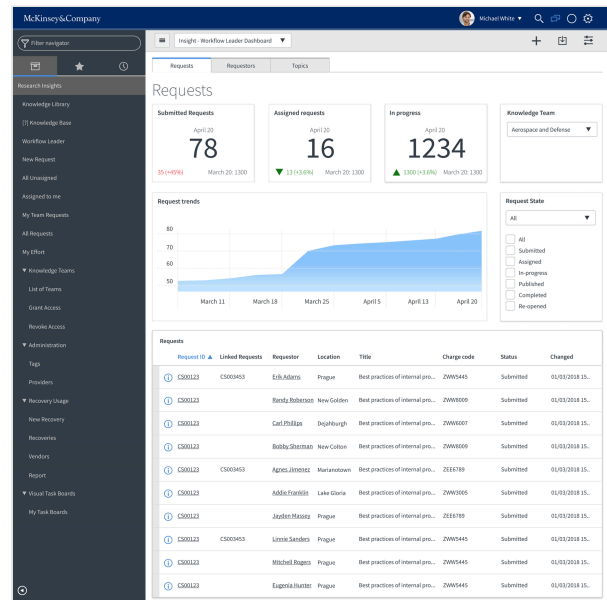
Research. Who uses the platform, and how — from persona to authentication to the right role-based view (dispatcher vs. team manager).



Planning. The full request lifecycle — every role, action and status mapped before anything was designed.



Planning. Charge-code validation — every valid and exception state worked out up front.



Back-end. The knowledge-team back-end on ServiceNow — the dashboard that replaced spreadsheets.

Research Insights — research · planning · back-end · front-end · alignment · adoption

Input priority

New Request Draft saved 2 min ago

1 Details 2 Attachments 3 Team

Charge code* Provide a valid charge code

Title* Short summary

Description What problem are you trying to solve?

Desired Outcome Is this a quick question or a deep research? Do you need to schedule a phone conversation?

Deadline 01/12/2018 17:00 CET 28

Spending Limit hrs

BACK NEXT

Mandatory input

Essential input

Optional input

Outcome tooltip
What kind of output do you need – Excel, PPT?
Do you prefer to schedule a phone conversation?

Front-end. The request form — inputs prioritised as mandatory, essential and optional.

McKinsey&Company Research Insights | Dashboard New Request Clara Desvire

Engagements

3214XB

AKO Rheinland/Hamburg

I am not part of this Client Team

Anderson Silva Engagement Director

Michael Thompson Engagement Manager

Jana Wilson Partner

Lorella Landolf Business Analyst

Erna Chaudry Business Analyst

6714DB

6924AC

4036XY

0565JH

6465WI

7865JH

3214XB

6534AC

7842DW

Show more

Requests

NEW REQUEST

Search by charge code, title, or requestor SEARCH

AI Only Active CG My requests

Title	Status	Requested by	Knowledge Team	Charge Code	Changed
Agriculture in Kazakhstan	Draft	Clara Desvire		214005	2d ago
Storage system providers	Ass...	Clara Desvire	Agriculture	3214XB	3d ago
Storage system providers in ...	Com...	Clara Desvire	Paper and Forest P...	3214XB	3d ago
Storage system providers in ...	Und...	Clara Desvire	Chemicals	3214XB	2d ago
Cold chain in emerginf marke...	Ass...	Anderson Silva	Service Operations	6714DB	7h ago
Top 5 Retail Trends in UK	Ass...	Anderson Silva	Service Operations	6714DB	2 mo
Europe Refinery mechanisation...	Com...	Anderson Silva	Service Operations	6714DB	7h ago
Top C-level trends in analyt...	Com...	Jon Johns	CPG & Retail North...	6714DB	4d ago
Market data from Bloomberg...	Und...	Jon Johns	CPG & Retail North...	9804AC	5d ago

< 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 >

What's new? [View all requests](#) Suggestions? [Send us feedback](#)

Front-end. The requestor's portal — a searchable, filterable list of every request.

McKinsey&Company Research Insights | Dashboard New Request Clara Desvire

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6465WI

7865JH

3214XB

6534AC

7842DW

Show more

New Request Draft saved 2 min ago

1 Details 2 Attachments 3 Team: Automotive and Assembly

Charge Code Project or Team Charge Code

Title* Short summary

Description What would you like to solve?

Final Product Are you looking for a quick answer, some deep research, a phone conversation, or something else? (If it's something else, explain what you need)

Deadline 01/12/2018 17:00 CET 28

Spending Limit hrs

Please fill in all required fields marked with an asterisk

NEXT

Stakeholder alignment. Each request tied to the live engagement team, so the right stakeholders are aligned from the start.

Insight | Dashboard New Request Clara Desvire

Requests

NEW REQUEST

Search by charge code, title or requestor SEARCH

Your last search: 3214XB, 3214XB Clara, CPG

Title	Status	Requested by
Agriculture in Kazakhstan	Draft	Clara Desvire
Storage system providers	Ass...	Clara Desvire
Storage system providers in ...	Com...	Clara Desvire
Storage system providers in ...	Und...	Clara Desvire
Cold chain in emerginf marke...	Ass...	Anderson Silva
Top 5 Retail Trends in UK	Ass...	Anderson Silva
Europe Refinery mechanisation...	Com...	Anderson Silva
Top C-level trends in analyt...	Comp...	Jon Johns
Market data from Bloomberg...	Und...	Jon Johns

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User adoption. A responsive, mobile-friendly view to drive adoption across teams.

At 20, with 100,000 kids waiting.

A primary-school textbook for the Slovak Ministry of Education.

No boss — I was the freelancer.

If September slipped, **~2,000 schools — around 100,000 children** — would start the year without their book. My stakeholders were the publisher and the Ministry, directly. I was twenty, and I'd been recommended for one reason: the artist they'd chosen said I was a hard worker.

The thing that nearly sank it: the writers and artist were delivering too slowly, and I was wasting days trying to cram finished artwork into whatever space was left, resizing it, losing text. So I flipped the process: I built the **skeleton of the book first** — the structure — and let everyone fill into it. Writers wrote to the space; the artist made art to fit the page. I even wrote **Photoshop actions to batch-process the scanned artwork** into print-ready files, so the repetitive work ran itself.

Given a year, I had the printed book on the shelf in **nine months**. I didn't know the words "design system" or "wireframe" yet — but that structure-first instinct is the exact move I've made on every project since.

I improve how the whole team works — not just the design.

Hudson · Barclays · McKinsey

In large organisations the design is rarely the real bottleneck — the way the team works is. So that's what I fix: the rules, the templates, the workflows and the communication that everyone downstream depends on.

- **Hudson** — built global brand rules + template libraries → production time **–20%**, regional inconsistencies **–30–35%**.
- **Barclays / banking** — enterprise-scale delivery for a major London financial institution.
- **McKinsey** — redesigned how work reached engineering → faster routing, fewer bugs, happier teams (Card 05).

Same move every time: improve the system, and the whole team gets faster — not just me.

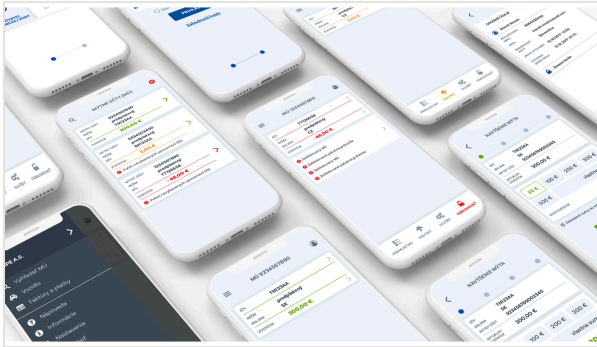
One person, every hat.

Fox Hunter · Codewell

In agencies I was never just "the designer." I was PM, scrum master, researcher, designer, account manager, hiring manager and coach — running stakeholder management, and performance and compensation reviews — often all at once. And I built the ways of working that actually let the team deliver.

- **Codewell** — PM + scrum master + researcher + designer simultaneously; led a cross-functional team of **15** → time-to-market **−20–25%**.
- **Fox Hunter** — led delivery for Lenovo, Philips, IBM & Vitana → adoption/engagement **+30–35%**.
- **Throughout** — hired, built teams, coached juniors, and owned the client & stakeholder relationships end to end.

Selected work — agency projects



Codewell. eMyto mobile app for the Slovak government.



FoxHunter. Lenovo Promoter website and mobile app.

Structure first. Automate the repetitive work. Align the people.

The same method, whether it's a textbook or an enterprise platform.

- **Structure first.** I build the skeleton before the surface — the system, the workflow, the information architecture — so everything that follows has a place. (It's how I delivered a textbook at 20, and how I redesign platforms now.)
- **Automate the repetitive work.** It should run itself. From Photoshop actions to template libraries to workflow automation, I take the boring repetitive work off people so they can spend their time where it counts.
- **Align the people.** No tool fixes how people behave or how motivated they are — honest research, clear communication and solving problems together do. That's usually the real work.

Pick the shape that fits.

Same person, different sized problems.

I'm a bit of a chameleon — I adapt to what the company and the team actually need, instead of chasing an exact job title. But the way I work never changes: structure first, automate the repetitive, align the people.

- **Lead product design end to end** — research, strategy and delivery on complex enterprise work (and the product-manager work when it's missing).
- **Fix a broken workflow, process or service** — find what's really wrong (usually people, not tools) and sort it out. This is service design.
- **Build and manage a design team** — hire, mentor, set the standard.
- **Advisory / fractional** — drop in where you need the experience, not a full-time hire.

“I would hire her again.”

A McKinsey stakeholder, a developer on my team, a client, and the manager I reported to — in their words.

“Lesia has been instrumental in researching and designing our new risk portal, aligning many stakeholders to migrate it from Drupal to ServiceNow. She is thoughtful, collaborative and an excellent framer — she does the research, builds a holistic view, and knows how to guide teams to the right answer while still offering options.”

— **Senior Manager, Enterprise Risk (project stakeholder) · McKinsey & Company**

“We worked with Lesia on several projects, mostly mobile apps. As a designer she created modern designs tailored to each app, with a positive response from customers. As a project manager she set good rules, was always open to discussion, and created ideal conditions to finish on time.”

— **Software Developer (reported to Lesia) · Codewell, Bratislava**

“Lesia was a great partner in creating brand elements for three brands — brochures, flyers, newsletters, webpages, stylebooks, anything we wished for. Tight deadlines or a wide range of feedback are no problem for her. She manages her projects with a lot of energy and creativity. A pleasure to work with.”

— **Marketing & Communications Manager · (Lesia's client) · Amsterdam**

“We consolidated much of Hudson's brand design function into a shared resource team in Prague, and Lesia was a foundational member — serving internal clients all over the world, from Asia to London. What impressed me most was her dedication to getting the job done, tactically and creatively, while keeping brand strategy firmly in mind. She has the potential to grow into a strong brand design manager. I would hire her again.”

— **Senior Vice President, Design & Marketing (managed Lesia) · Hudson, Chicago**

Paintbrush in hand before I could speak.

Born in Kyiv into two generations of painters. Raised in galleries — and in my father's print house.

Print taught me there's no "undo" — you get it right the first time. So I chose computers, honestly, for the Ctrl+Z. I've lived in both worlds ever since: the discipline of print, the freedom of the screen.

I watch crime documentaries to solve the case before the detective does — which is more or less how I work. I read the room, see the real person behind the title, and I'll give you honest feedback whether or not you asked. **No bullshit.** I can't fake enthusiasm and I can't hide it either — so you always know where you stand with me.

Off the clock: gardening, and interior design that's actually *functional*, not just for looks. Slovak & Russian native, English fluent, Ukrainian conversational.

My favourite line, and how I actually live: **Design your life to live and love it.** It's all in our hands.

Prague • [linkedin.com/in/lesiabilo](https://www.linkedin.com/in/lesiabilo)